



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Maldives. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that—it's great that you're thinking about your next steps early. Since you've just finished primary school in Denmark (which usually means up to 9th or 10th grade), your next step will typically be **upper secondary education (ungdomsuddannelse)**. Denmark offers several different paths depending on your interests, goals, and how you like to learn.

Here's a breakdown of your main options, along with recommendations based on different goals:

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

These are ideal if you're thinking about going to university later.

a. STX (Studentereksamen) – General upper secondary school

- Focus: Broad education (science, languages, social studies, etc.)
- Good for: University-bound students who want general flexibility
- Duration: 3 years

b. HHX (Higher Commercial Examination Programme)

- Focus: Business, economics, and international trade
- Good for: Future business, marketing, or finance careers
- Duration: 3 years

c. HTX (Higher Technical Examination Programme)

- Focus: Technology, science, IT, and innovation
- Good for: Future engineers, programmers, or scientists
- Duration: 3 years

d. HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)

- Focus: More practically oriented, shorter (2 years)
- Good for: Students who want a faster route to higher education or prefer a less theoretical environment

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - VET)

If you're more interested in hands-on work and want to start a career sooner.

- Focus: Practical skills + apprenticeships in a trade (e.g. electrician, mechanic, hairdresser, chef, etc.)
- Good for: Students who prefer learning by doing and want job opportunities quickly
- Duration: 2–5 years (including apprenticeships)

3. EUX (Combination of VET and Academic Education)

This path combines **vocational training with academic studies**—you get both a trade and a qualification to enter university.

- Good for: Students who want practical skills but don't want to close the door to higher education
- Duration: Around 4–5 years

Personal Recommendation

Since you're fluent in Danish, have multicultural roots, and have just completed school in Denmark, here are some factors to consider:

- **Do you enjoy academic subjects and think about university?**
→ Go for **STX**, **HTX**, or **HHX** depending on your interests.
- **Do you like practical, hands-on work and want to start earning earlier?**
→ Choose **VET** or **EUX** for more direct job access.
- **Are you unsure but want to keep doors open?**
→ **EUX** is a great flexible option. Or go with **STX** if you prefer a more traditional school setting.

Extra Tip:

Explore “**brobygning**” (**bridge-building programs**) where you can try out different educations before choosing. Also, many schools offer open house events—go visit and talk to students and teachers!

If you tell me more about:

- Your interests (e.g. tech, art, business, healthcare, etc.)
- Whether you enjoy school subjects
- If you'd prefer hands-on work or studying

...then I can give you a more tailored suggestion!